

In GPU-based benchmarks also, the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G beats the Nothing Phone (2a) but the competition is extremely close. For example, in the 3D Mark Wildlife Extreme test, the OnePlus Nord 4 5G still differentiates itself with higher points, but in benchmarks like GFXBench, the difference is not that great.

So yes, in terms of performance, the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G is up there with some of the best performing mid-range smartphones that have launched in 2024 so far. Be it in terms of the benchmark scores, or in terms of day-to-day usage, or even in terms of CPU throttling (OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G throttled to 80 percent of its performance), the performance of the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G will not disappoint any of its users.

BATTERY

The OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G comes with a 5,500mAh battery which is bigger than last year's OnePlus Nord CE 3 5G's 5,000mAh battery. We also get faster charging this year with 100W fast charging, as compared to the 80W fast charging on the OnePlus Nord CE 3 from last year. The backup, you ask? It's very good. The OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G doesn't show signs of battery drain at all. At least for the time I used the smartphone, the battery backup was brilliant.

Playing a game of Call of Duty Warzone Mobile for 15 minutes only drained 4 percent of the OnePlus Nord CE 4's battery. Watching a YouTube video for 30 minutes on the highest resolution and about 80 percent brightness drained only 3 percent of the battery, and using GPS for an hour constantly drained just 5 percent of the battery. These are great numbers, if we compare them to some of the recent smartphones we have tested for battery.

Pair this with one of the fastest charging in the segment, the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G makes for a beautiful battery experience. The 100W fast charging juiced up the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G from 0 to 100 percent in just about 40 minutes. That, in a sub-Rs 30,000 smartphone is great by any standard.

CAMERA

This year, OnePlus has taken away

one shooter from the smartphone. The OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G comes with a dual rear camera setup as compared to a triple rear camera setup on the OnePlus Nord CE 3 5G from last year. The company has decided to let go of the macro shooter and only stuck with the primary 50-megapixel shooter and an 8-megapixel ultra-wide angle shooter.

Now, the cameras are actually a downgrade as compared to last year. For example, the sensor size of the 50-megapixel primary shooter is now smaller. The OnePlus Nord CE 3 5G had a 1/1.56-inch sensor size, while the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G comes with a 1/1.93-inch sensor size. This obviously results in a smaller pixel size, meaning that theoretically, the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G will capture less details.

But the results aren't all that bad. Yes, there is a downgrade in terms of the camera hardware, the results aren't too different in terms of quality. The primary shooter captures enough detail in all lighting conditions. In bright sunlight, the colours seem washed out at times, and the dynamic range seems a bit soft. But overall, the images that come out of this shooter are good for your social media usage and have sufficient detail to allow you to edit your photos to make them look good.

In low light also, the camera is decent. In fact, the colours seemed more vibrant in low light conditions and the details remain intact, even in extremely low light conditions. In low light, the OnePlus Nord CE 4's camera optimises the shutter speed according to the light and at times, even in no light, the camera took in enough light from nearby sources to create the image and make it seem nice and vibrant. Not the best for enthusiasts who want a true-to-life image, but great for casual users who just want to capture a moment.

However, in low light photos, I experienced a lot of light flare in images, but that's not a deal breaker since this is not a flagship smartphone with fancy coatings on the lens to manage light flare. Another thing about the camera that really bothered me is that in low light shots, the focus feels slow since the smartphone takes a few seconds or at times, multiple attempts to focus on a subject in low light.

Further, like in almost every phone in this range, the images from the ultrawide angle shooter and primary shooter aren't consistent. The colours from the wide angle shooter seem to be a bit more washed out and there is a bit of a warm tone to the images by default.

So the camera is decent, but not the best. Yes, you can click very good images from this camera, but that's not the case with every image you take. Based on my experience, I would give this camera a 7 out of 10.

VERDICT

So the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G is quite a basic mid-range smartphone for the Indian market. The smartphone looks good with the marble-like finish on the back panel. There is also exceptional performance going for it. The smartphone is ahead of most of the rivals in terms of the performance, so that is great. Add to that an exceptional battery and charging combination, and the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G showcases all the traits for being a dependable workhorse.

However, the camera and display are something that didn't please me as much as the battery and performance on this smartphone. While the display is good for watching content and gaming, it emits too much blue light, which can have adverse effects on the user's eyes in the long run. The camera, on the other hand, is just average to say the least.

But yes, if you are looking for a reliable workhorse in a mid-range segment, the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G is very easy to recommend. But if you want a brilliant camera and display to go with it, this may not be the best option for you.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: Qualcomm Snapdragon 7 Gen 3 | GPU: Adreno 720 | OS: OxygenOS 14 based on Android 14 | Display: 6.7-inch FHD+ Fluid AMOLED display | Display Refresh Rate: 120Hz | RAM: 8GB | ROM: Up to 256GB | Cameras (rear): 50MP + 8MP + 2MP | Cameras (front): 16MP | Video: 4K @ 30fps | Battery: 5500mAh | Charging: 100W

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